

Kofi Ampoma Asuako

ampomaasuako22@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/kofi-asuako | +1 678-886-3989

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a macroeconomist whose research focuses on macro-financial stability and the design of monetary policy frameworks in emerging and developing economies. I use structural models and empirical methods to analyze how the fiscal-monetary policy mix interacts with financial intermediation to influence business cycles, asset prices, and systemic risk. My objective is to contribute to the development of coherent policy frameworks that enhance financial resilience, strengthen fiscal-monetary coordination, and foster sustainable and inclusive growth.

EDUCATION

Southern Illinois University Carbondale Ph.D. in Economics Fields: Macroeconomics and Finance	<i>Aug 2021 - Aug 2025</i>
Eastern Illinois University M.A. in Economics Fields: International and Managerial Economics	<i>Aug 2019 - May 2021</i>
Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST) B.A. in Economics, Minor in History Fields: Economics and Economic History	<i>Sep 2013 - Jul 2017</i>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Business cycles; macro-financial linkages; financial intermediation and financial crises; systemic risk and resilience in banking and non-banking sectors; monetary and fiscal policy interactions; debt sustainability; and macroprudential regulation.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Principles of Macroeconomics and Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Financial Economics, Applied Econometrics, MBA-level Macroeconomics, and Advanced Macroeconomic Theory.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Economics, Allen University	<i>Aug 2025 - Present</i>
Graduate Instructor, Southern Illinois University Carbondale	<i>Aug 2021 - May 2025</i>
Graduate Instructor, Eastern Illinois University	<i>Aug 2019 - May 2021</i>
Teaching & Research Assistant, KNUST	<i>Aug 2017 - Aug 2018</i>

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Credit Analyst, Ejuraman Rural Bank Evaluated creditworthiness, monitored loan performance, and advised on risk exposure.	<i>Jan 2019 - Jul 2019</i>
Research Intern, Ecobank Ghana Ltd. Conducted market surveys and analyzed customer data to support strategic planning.	<i>May 2016 - Aug 2016</i>

PUBLICATIONS

Fiscal Dominance and Banking Sector Fragility in Frontier African Economies: The Financial Stability Effects of Money-Financed Deficits

Revise and Resubmit at African Review of Economics and Finance.

WORKING PAPERS

Do Inflation Surprises Undermine Banking Sector Stability? Empirical Evidence from Ghana

Working Paper.

DISSERTATION & THESES

Ph.D. Dissertation (2025)

Fiscal Dominance and Bank Fragility in Frontier Economies: Theory and Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa. Southern Illinois University Carbondale.

Master's Thesis (2021)

Trade Integration and Economic Growth in Africa: Lessons from SADC and ECOWAS. Eastern Illinois University.

Bachelor's Thesis (2017)

The Effect of External Debt on Economic Growth in Ghana: An Econometric Analysis. Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor of Economics - Allen University, Columbia, South Carolina

Aug 2025 - Present

ECON 201 - Principles of Microeconomics
ECON 202 - Principles of Macroeconomics
FIN 361 - Investment Management and Securities Valuation
BUS 513 - MBA-level Managerial Statistics
BUS 517 - MBA-level Quantitative Analysis

Graduate Instructor - Southern Illinois University Carbondale

Aug 2023 - May 2025

ECON 241 - Introduction to Macroeconomics
ECON 351 - History of Economic Systems
ECON 341 - Intermediate Macroeconomics
ECON 416 - Financial Economics

Teaching Assistant - Southern Illinois University Carbondale

Aug 2021 - May 2023

ECON 241 - Introduction to Macroeconomics
ECON 463 - Mathematical Economics
ECON 315 - Money and Banking
ECON 341 - Intermediate Macroeconomics

Graduate Instructor - Eastern Illinois University

Aug 2019 - May 2021

ECN 2801 - Principles of Macroeconomics
ECN 2802 - Principles of Microeconomics

Advised undergraduate students on academic progress and career pathways.

Teaching & Research Assistant - Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)

Aug 2017 - Aug 2018

Assisted in teaching undergraduate courses including Economic Statistics, Financial Economics, and Advanced Macroeconomic Theory.

Provided research support through data analysis, econometric modeling, and literature review.

TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

My teaching philosophy is grounded in clarity, rigor, and student engagement. I aim to make economic and financial concepts accessible without sacrificing analytical depth, emphasizing intuition alongside formal reasoning. In my courses, I connect theory to real-world policy issues and empirical evidence, encouraging students to think critically about how economic models inform decision-making in practice.

I prioritize an inclusive and supportive learning environment in which students with diverse backgrounds can develop confidence in quantitative and analytical skills. To this end, I use a combination of lectures, applied problem-solving, data-driven exercises, and discussion-based learning to reinforce key concepts. I also emphasize clear communication, ethical reasoning, and disciplined thinking as essential competencies for both academic and professional success.

Overall, my goal is to equip students with the tools needed to analyze complex economic and financial problems, evaluate policy trade-offs, and apply rigorous reasoning in graduate study, professional careers, and civic life.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Illinois Economic Association, Presenter

Oct 2023

Missouri Valley Economics Association, Presenter

Oct 2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: Julia, Python, MATLAB, Stata, EViews

Modeling: DSGE, Time Series, Structural Estimation

Documentation: LaTeX, Microsoft Office Suite

REFERENCES

Dr. Zsolt Becsi - Associate Professor, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

becsi@siu.edu | (618) 453-5067

Dr. Kevin Sylwester - Professor and Director, School of Analytics, Finance, and Economics, SIU

ksylwest@siu.edu | (618) 453-5075

Dr. Alison Watts - Professor of Economics, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

wattsa@siu.edu | (618) 453-5073

Dr. Scott Gilbert - Associate Professor of Economics, Southern Illinois University Carbondale

gilberts@siu.edu | (618) 453-5095